Swimming

54

Across the tours

Written for the 2026 countdown to BDT 2026 in Scottsdale



The La Manga Pool

In Memory 88 we recalled the genesis of the Duncan Goodhew Challenge but, aside from this great event, swimming has been a constant theme of the tour.

Starting with BDT 2003, the pool at La Manga provided much entertainment including daily royal rumbles with one Dog on top of another's shoulders scrapping with another – which was discontinued when Marshy discovered Robbo's lad resting on his shoulder!



Dogs In The Pool

In Lagos on BDT 2004, many of the lads decided to swim across the Marina at 2am whilst three sheets to the wind – seemed like a good idea at the time! Knoxy explains in more detail (and guess who provoked the swim...!):



KNOXY

"A group of wild hounds were on their way back to their kennels after an A-Typical night on the beers in Lagos! One rather loud dog (Ravo) started to bark up about the fact that the Bloodhounds were the only real Big Dogs! With a pack of Retrievers present this barking escalated to some good old "paw beating chest" banter. Ultimately leading to one dog making a reeediculous shout of, 'if you are such a Big Dog why don't you swim that?!'.

Now I am not sure many breeds of dawg are natural swimmers and I am sure that after a night at the beer bowl their hairy paws are even less well equipped to deal with watter! However, courage is stronger than sense with this pack and no sooner had Ravo Dog stripped down to his M+S best, the rest of the pack had done enough paw beating to ensure that no self-respecting mutt could be left not taking on the challenge!

"That" was the seemingly innocent looking estuary leading from the harbour to the ocean, and next stop the Americas!



The Scene of the Lagos Swim!

Not content with completing the task a decision was also made that the only stroke that could be employed was dawgy paddel. Some of you may remember this being sufficient to propel your puppy-like bodies; however with us being fully fledged Big Dogs also carrying a barrel full of beer in the gut, it was soon apparent that the preferred stroke was no longer up to the job.

The 40m (each way) stretch of watter was made more complicated to navigate when taking into effect the small issue of the tidal effect of the Atlantic Ocean, a pack of chuckling dawgs and the consumption of some of Portugal's best faecal watter!

On the return leg Knoxy dawg and BBT had to slow down whilst others in the pack arranged their exit on the one ladder out of the Ocean! Suddenly the current started to pick up and both dawgs began drifting down stream! After breaking dawgy paddle we finally got our paws back on dry ground and after accounting for all the dawgs we made our way back to the kennels, very pleased with our exploits.

Next day in town we recounted this story to a local who informed us that two people had drowned doing the same thing! But they weren't BIG DOGS!!! For those dawgs that had forgotten about our late-night excursion I hope this jogged a memory or two! As a Dog that often has a problem carrying the watter I won't be repeating the exercise! Good craic though!”

On the Dark Tour to Vilamoura on BDT 2005, several of us found ourselves in the fountain in the middle of the square towards the end of an evening, whether voluntarily or (in the case of Robbo!) not.

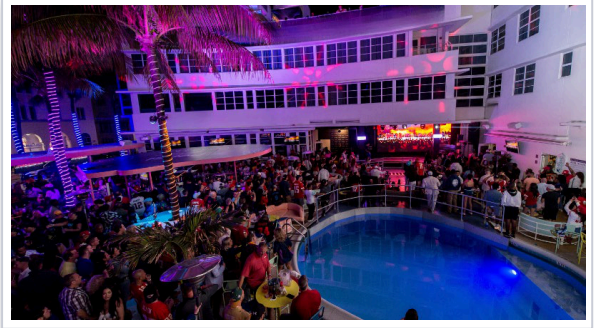


▶ **Watch:** Robbo Takes A Dip (as does Ravo – trust me!)



▶ **Watch:** Into The Vilamoura Fountain!

In Miami on BDT 2011, Coxy went for a little ‘unplanned’ dip in the pool at the Clevelander en route to the bar and had to be fished out with a rubber ring (video footage would be priceless)!





Coxy At The Clevelander!

Miami also saw Ravo taking a dip at The Great White Course! One Craaaaaaaaaaaazy Mutherf*cker!



▶ **Watch:** Ravo Takes A Mid-Round Dip!

El Bosque GC in Valencia on BDT 2018 witnessed the fourball of (yet again) Ravo, Boysie, BT & Rufus refreshing themselves right in front of us on the 8th hole!



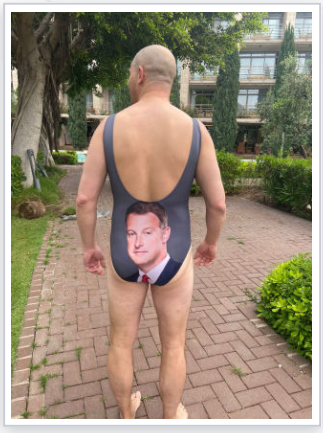
The 8th at El Bosque



Team Dip At El Bosque!

Continuing the swimming theme leads us to the greatest show of disrespect in tour history when Hulmey unveiled his swimming cossie on BDT 2023. Subsequent showings also came on BDT 2024 and 2025, when opposition skipper Gav also fell victim to Hulmey's inventiveness!!











Hulmey's Cossies!

Finally, back to La Manga and BDT 2003 where Boggy found himself swimming on the La Manga North Course, playing in a fourball with Ash, Picko and.....Ravo! Over to Boggy to explain himself (and guess who was the main enforcer...!).



BOGGY

"I'd had a steady start to the final day and think I was 1 over through 5. I started thinking that I may well be able to play my way into contention for the Green Jacket, but quickly came to realise that this would most certainly not be the case if Ravo had anything to do with it!

It was on the 6th tee that the lady selling demon repellent, as Robbo so eloquently puts it, showed up. I was reluctant, to say the least, because beer on a golf course seems to attract the demons to me, in the same way that an Eastern European's perfume attracts Ash! It didn't take much for the ever-persuasive Ravo to convince us that a beer a hole was now par for the course and we should leave our empty tins on each tee, in different shapes, for the fourball behind to admire our drinking prowess!

In the searing heat, the beer was quickly going to our heads and it was around the 10th hole that Ravo came up with the great/ridicadog idea of a long drive competition after he spotted a long par 5 fairway, just adjacent to the hole we were playing. The loser of the long drive competition had to jump in the pond just next to said fairway. Feeling merry, we all agreed, thinking Ravo would forget by the time we got there as he was still trying to learn the lyrics to 'Your Song' and saying 'Schmoker' every other word!

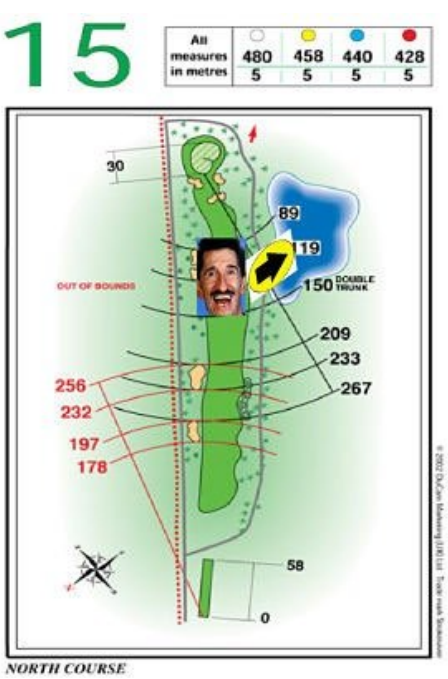
The hole in question comes around (the 15th) and we're all getting pretty schmokered by this point, so needless to say, stood on the tee, we'd all forgotten.

I drive off first, straight, but it came down with snow on! The other 3 then spanked theirs past mine with no problems whatsoever. Slowly realising our surroundings, as a fairway we'd seen before but couldn't quite place, Ravo pipes up, "Boggy, I think this is the long drive hole. In the pond you go!"

With Ravo's arm around my shoulder trying to convince me that this was a good thing to do, as I was one of the Virgins on Tour, I was surprised with the relative ease I succumbed to the peer pressure, as I found myself sprinting stark b*llock naked, across the fairway and proceeded to dive straight into the pond (a pond which I found out later contained a number of snakes - GOOD!).



La Manga North Course's 15th Hole



Barry's Swim!

As I was getting used to skinny dipping on this tour by now, I flapped around for a while before I realised I couldn't get out, partly due to the fact that the sides of the pond had that black plastic, slippy stuff on the bottom and partly due to the fact that my coordination might not have been 100% there, after the 8 beers I'd just snotted. Ravo had to fish me out with his Big Dog! I then blobbed the last 3 holes!

It's a good job no-one else was around, apart from the Dogs, because we could quite possibly have been thrown out of the resort or, someone might've thought they'd seen some new species of animal that had 3 legs and tried to report his finding. ☺

Not My Finest Hour!"





Boggy in La Manga